



FRANCIS WEB AGENCY · BRAND GUIDE

Your site should **pay for** **itself.**

The complete identity — positioning, voice, and visual system. Version 2.1
— the Highlighter system, calibrated through homepage review.

V2.1 · 2026 · HIGHLIGHTER — ONE FAMILY, GEIST
SUPERSEDES V1.0 (DEEP-TEAL SYSTEM)
VALDOSTA, GA

Websites as revenue infrastructure — built by the person you actually talk to.

Francis Web Agency builds websites that pay for themselves. A website isn't decoration; it's a growth asset with a job to do, and every design and engineering decision ties back to the number that matters to the client: more calls, more bookings, more signups, more sales. Delivered by one person — the one who sells the site is the one who builds it.

THE ONE-LINER

High-performing websites and web apps, built by the person you actually talk to, measured by the business they bring in.

TAGLINE — DISPLAY CONTEXTS ONLY, CITRINE SWEEP ON THE CLAIM

Your site should pay for itself.

Small lockups (business card, email signature) drop the tagline — the uppercase "VALDOSTA, GA" tag does that job.

What we sell, in order

- **Outcomes** — leads, conversions, revenue. Shown, not claimed.
- **Performance** — speed is revenue. Sub-second loads.
- **Direct access** — no account manager, no hand-offs.
- **Honesty** — the truth even when it costs the sale.

Who it's for

Small businesses and growing teams that treat their website as an investment that should return — not a checkbox. They buy on results and respect straight talk.

A sharp, plain-spoken peer who leads with your problem and tells you the truth.

Personality rides on top of competence, never instead of it. Every relatable line is anchored to a concrete claim.

The four pillars

- **Professional** — credibility from concrete detail, not adjectives.
- **Friendly** — a helpful person, not a brochure. Contractions, "you."
- **Business savvy** — lead with outcomes; respect time and budget.
- **Modern & human** — dry wit, zero buzzwords. A peer, not a vendor.

The signature moves

- **Open on the reader's problem** — a money problem in disguise.
- **Plain language as a promise** — "that's what you're hiring me for."
- **Honesty as the differentiator** — say when the cheap option is right.
- **Specificity as proof** — numbers instead of adjectives.
- **The solo advantage** — "the person you talked to builds it."
- **One wry line per section** — wit seasons; it isn't the meal.

REFERENCE COPY — THE VOICE AT WORK

"Your website should be pulling its weight. Most don't. Let's fix that."

"When you email, I answer. No account manager, no hand-off, no wondering who's actually building your site."

"If a feature is going to cost you money and confuse your customers, I'll say so — before you pay for it, not after."

Confident, never folksy. Warm, never cute.

Do

- Start with the reader's problem
- Replace adjectives with numbers
- Say the honest thing, not the easy sell
- Use contractions and "you"
- Cut any word the sentence survives without

Don't

- Open with credentials or location
- Undercut the work with self-deprecation
- Use profanity or internet/meme voice
- Pile on wit — one landed line per section
- Use emoji. Ever.

Words we don't use

leverage · seamless · unlock · empower · cutting-edge · best-in-class · synergy · simply · just ·
game-changer · robust · solutions (as a catch-all) · world-class

Before / after

- ✗ "Welcome to Francis Web Agency, your full-service partner for cutting-edge web solutions."
✓ "Your website should be pulling its weight. Most don't. Let's fix that."

- ✗ "We pride ourselves on exceptional communication and customer service."
✓ "When you email, I answer. No account manager, no hand-off."

- ✗ "Contact us today to unlock your online potential!"
✓ "Tell me where things stand, and I'll tell you honestly whether I can help — and what it'd take."

The test: if a line would feel wrong set in Geist over the citrine sweep, rewrite it. Full playbook:
voice-guide.md.

The mark survives the rebrand — it was always ink.



Rules (unchanged from v1)

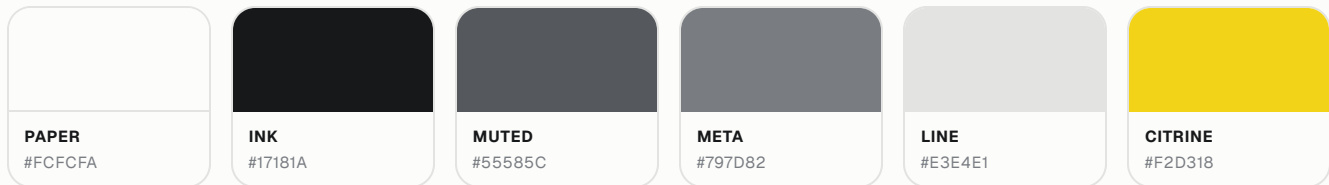
- Monochrome only: ink **#17181A** or paper **#F0F0EC** — never recolored
- Clear space = height of the inner "F" on all sides
- Lockup $\geq 120\text{px}$ wide; mark alone below 24px
- No stretching, rotating, shadows, or busy-image placement without a solid backing block

What changed in v2

- Ink value updates **#121817** → **#17181A**
- **App icon:** ink mark on a citrine tile — the one place citrine carries the mark (replaces the teal tile)
- Wordmark lockups reset in **Geist 700** (replacing Fraunces)
- Small lockup tag: **VALDOSTA, GA** in tracked-uppercase Geist

Ink on paper, one highlighter.

The palette is deliberately plain — near-white ground, near-black ink — so a single citrine accent can do the work of a whole color system. Citrine means brand emphasis, and only that.



The citrine laws

- **Never a text color.** Backgrounds, rules, fills only; text on citrine is always ink — on both themes.
- **Scarce by design.** Sweeps, 2px rules, hover floods, active markers. If it stops being the rarest thing on the page, it stops working.
- **Not a status color.** Warning is orange (#B45D0E), never yellow.

Structure

- Sections breathe paper → linen → ink moment; depth from surface contrast, not shadows (one exception: the featured pricing card)
- **One ink band per page** (marketing)
- Dark ramp exists for the app (see Design System); marketing ships light-only — the near-white ground is the brand

One family: Geist.

Geist — everything

700 display (−.03em) · 600 headings, buttons & labels · 400 body. Clean, Swiss-modern, plain — the plain-spoken voice in letterform. (A utility mono was trialed and retired: it read technical at any dosage.)

Utility roles — Geist treatments

Eyebrows & metadata: Geist 600, UPPERCASE, +0.08em, meta gray. Numerals: Geist 700 with tabular figures, so money and stats align like records.

Pay for itself. Prove it.

DISPLAY XL · GEIST 700 · −.03EM

Built Right the First Time

H3 · GEIST 600

You're hiring judgment, not just hands. That only works if I'm honest with you.

BODY · GEIST 400

CS-004 · RIVERBEND HVAC · LAUNCHED 02/2026 · LCP 0.8S

METADATA STRIP · GEIST 600 UPPERCASE

+38% · 0.9s · \$12,400

STAT NUMERALS · GEIST 700 TABULAR

The moves that make it **unmistakably FWA.**

- **The highlighter sweep** — citrine behind the honest clause of the sentence. One per view.
 - **2px citrine rules** — above stat rows and process steps; the underline on marked CTAs.
 - **Metadata strips** — uppercase case-study facts (CS-004 · LCP 0.8s) as a design device.
 - **The solid button speaks once per view** — every other CTA is marked, not shouted.
 - **One ink band per page** — this page is the reference: reserve the dark moment for the honesty message.
 - **Marker motion** — the citrine stroke paints across text on hover or scroll (services spotlight, painted prices). One interactive signature per section.
 - **No index labels** — numbers only where they carry meaning: prices, timelines, real case-study IDs.
 - **One wry line per section** — in copy and in design: one wink, everything else deadpan.
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Companion volume: the **Design System** — tokens, components, and the app translation. Sources of truth live in `BRAND/REBRAND/`.